

Micheal Breedlove

Security & Infrastructure Engineer

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SUMMARY

Security and infrastructure engineer and U.S. Army veteran (Unit Supply Specialist, 92Y; Signals Intelligence Analyst (35N) training; prior TS/SCI, eligible for reinvestigation) with operations leadership experience. Designed and operate a distributed AI cluster orchestration platform with adaptive task routing, shared operational memory, automated recovery workflows, and recurring disaster recovery validation. Focus areas include infrastructure automation, distributed systems, reliability engineering, recovery-first design, and operational documentation.

CORE SKILLS

Infrastructure Automation · Reliability Engineering · Distributed Systems · Linux Administration · Disaster Recovery · Platform Operations · Observability & Monitoring · Network Security · Configuration Management

EXPERIENCE

Infrastructure & Reliability Engineer

Independent / Self-Hosted Private Cloud | 2024 – Present

- Designed and operate a distributed orchestration platform coordinating four compute nodes with health-aware task routing and automated recovery workflows
- Implemented adaptive routing engine that scores task assignments based on node health, role fitness, and observed execution performance
- Built a durable file-based job queue with dispatch tracking, retry logic, stale-job detection, and failure isolation across shared storage
- Architected a shared operational knowledge system using a NAS-backed Markdown corpus with per-node local semantic indexes
- Deployed automated watchdog and recovery workflows that detect runtime degradation, quarantine bad state, and restore from verified backups
- Created a portable recovery bundle and monthly sandboxed DR drills to validate rebuild capability without touching live systems
- Implemented autonomous task generation with approval gating — safe operations execute automatically, risky actions require human review
- Managed a 3-node Proxmox virtualization cluster with ZFS-backed storage and automated snapshot policies at three retention tiers
- Configured OPNsense firewall with VLAN segmentation, SSH key-only authentication, and CI-enforced credential scanning
- Built SRE automation pipeline with SLO tracking, burn-rate alerting, automated incident management, and postmortem generation

Culinary Farm Manager

PRESS Napa Valley, St. Helena, CA | 2022 – Present

- Lead all on-site operations for a Michelin-starred restaurant farm, managing vendor relationships, seasonal planning, and budget allocation
- Improved crop yield utilization through targeted planting strategies and data-informed seasonal adjustments
- Implemented inventory and tracking systems to optimize crop cycles and minimize waste
- Previously served as Chef de Partie (2022–2024), executing precision work in a high-volume, high-pressure kitchen environment

Director of Operations

Empyrean Commerce | 2019 – 2025

- Directed e-commerce operations across Amazon, Walmart, and eBay platforms, earning Top Seller status
- Managed marketing, technology, and procurement budgets exceeding \$500K annually
- Built vendor relationships, negotiated contracts, and ensured supply chain reliability
- Integrated third-party technologies for site search, email marketing, and conversion optimization

Chef de Partie

The Restaurant at Meadowood (3-star) & others | 2016 – 2019

- Led daily preparation and execution in a 3-Michelin-star kitchen, managing a team of commis chefs
- Coordinated with guest chefs and participated in R&D projects under high-pressure service conditions
- Developed expertise in process optimization, team coordination, and maintaining exceptional standards

Unit Supply Specialist (92Y); Signals Intelligence Analyst (35N) Trainee

United States Army | 2012 – 2015 | Prior TS/SCI — eligible for reinvestigation

- As Unit Supply Specialist, managed requisition, receipt, storage, issue, and accountability of organizational property including weapons, sensitive items, and controlled equipment.
- Maintained property book and hand-receipt records in GCSS-Army; executed cyclic, sensitive-item, and change-of-command inventories with zero loss.
- Managed arms room operations including physical security, key control, and access rosters.
- Prepared supply documentation supporting audits and inspections.

- Completed approximately 90% of Signals Intelligence Analyst (35N) Advanced Individual Training at Goodfellow AFB, Texas, including instruction in SIGINT collection fundamentals, traffic analysis, reporting procedures, and intelligence community security practices. Held fully adjudicated TS/SCI with CI polygraph throughout training. Reclassified to 92Y prior to course completion.

SELECTED ENGINEERING PROJECTS

AI Cluster Orchestration Platform

Distributed control plane with adaptive routing, shared operational memory, and automated recovery. [View Architecture](#) →

SRE Reliability Pipeline

SLO tracking, burn-rate alerting, incident management, and safety-gated automation. [Case Study](#) →

GitOps Backup System

Automated backups with CI-enforced secret scanning and credential hygiene. [Case Study](#) →

EDUCATION

B.S. Cybersecurity & Information Assurance — Western Governors University (2026 – Present, In Progress)

AOS, Culinary Arts — The Culinary Institute of America (2016 – 2018)

CERTIFICATIONS

- CompTIA Tech+ (Earned 2025)
- CompTIA Security+ (In Progress, Target 2026)

TECHNICAL TOOLS

Python · Bash · PowerShell · Ansible · YAML · Jinja2 · Proxmox · KVM · systemd · OPNsense · VLANs · Tailscale · ZFS · TrueNAS · NFS · Git · GitHub Actions · CI/CD · SQLite · JSON · Docker · Linux · Windows Server · HTML · CSS · JavaScript